

MAKING THE MOST OF MILITARY BENEFITS

Know What You Deserve if You Serve

IF YOU ARE one of the millions of young people who have served in the military, National Guard, or reserves in the last few years, you've earned some benefits not available to most people. Below is a rundown, and when you're ready to get more details on the programs, go to the National Military Family Association (www.nmfa.org).

- **Student loan forgiveness.** If you went to an accredited college before enlisting, the military will pay off \$1,500 of your unpaid federal student loans or a third of the amount you owe (whichever is greater) for every year of active duty, up to a maximum of \$65,000 for the Army and Navy and a max of \$10,000 for the Air Force. This includes all PLUS, Perkins, and Stafford loans. So if you owe \$10,000 and served for two years, the military will cover \$6,667. Make sure you take advantage of this if you're eligible. You may also qualify for loan forgiveness if you were in the National Guard or the Reserves. To get more information, go to www.finaid.org/military.